

Chosanta – Missing Items & Compliance Gaps Report

This report outlines the most important operational, governance, and compliance gaps identified during the internal review of the Chosanta documentation pack for Tusla/HIQA-style emergency and special arrangements services.

1. Emergency Placement Procedure

A dedicated emergency placement procedure is still strongly recommended. This should include:

- Emergency admissions workflow
- Out-of-hours escalation
- Placement compatibility assessment
- Immediate safeguarding checks
- Healthcare escalation
- Overnight staffing arrangements
- Referral acceptance criteria

2. Missing Child / Absconding Procedure

A standalone missing child procedure is likely required. This should include:

- Search procedures
- Garda notification thresholds
- Escalation timelines
- Return interviews
- Incident recording requirements
- Family/social worker notifications

3. Recruitment & Vetting Governance

A formal recruitment and safer hiring framework should be clearly documented. Recommended additions:

- Recruitment policy
- Interview process
- Personnel file checklist
- Reference verification process
- Qualification verification
- Probation procedures

4. Staff Supervision & Performance Management

Inspectors will usually expect evidence of formal supervision systems. Recommended additions:

- Supervision policy
- Supervision templates
- Appraisal system
- Performance review process
- Reflective practice records

5. Training Governance

Policies reference training obligations, but operational evidence systems may still be missing. Recommended systems:

- Training matrix
- Training expiry tracker
- Staff induction checklist
- Mandatory training schedule
- Competency sign-off process

6. Quality Assurance & Audit Systems

A formal governance oversight system is likely still needed. Recommended additions:

- Internal audit schedule
- Monthly governance reviews
- Incident trend analysis
- Quality improvement plans
- KPI monitoring
- Service review meetings

7. Operational Evidence Folder

The largest remaining risk is inability to demonstrate implementation. Recommended evidence files:

- Completed incident reports
- Fire drill logs
- Medication audits
- Staff training certificates
- Garda vetting records
- Staff supervision notes
- Placement risk assessments
- Complaints logs
- Maintenance logs

8. Governance Structure Documentation

Tusla/HIQA may require clearer governance mapping. Recommended additions:

- Organisational chart
- Reporting hierarchy
- On-call escalation structure
- Governance accountability framework
- Named responsible persons

9. Children's Participation & Consultation

There appears to be limited evidence around children's participation systems. Recommended additions:

- Child consultation process
- Accessible complaints process
- Feedback systems

- Advocacy engagement records
- Child participation meetings

10. Premises & Environmental Compliance

Operational premises evidence may still be required. Recommended additions:

- Fire certification
- Maintenance schedules
- Environmental risk assessments
- Cleaning schedules
- Food safety records
- Water temperature checks
- Bedroom suitability checks

Priority Risk Summary

Priority Area	Risk Level
Emergency Placement Procedure	High
Missing Child Procedure	High
Recruitment & Vetting Governance	High
Training Evidence Systems	High
Quality Assurance Framework	Moderate–High
Operational Evidence Folder	Critical
Governance Structure	Moderate